

# Nscale

AI Infrastructure · Sovereign GPU Cloud / Data-Centre Builder · London · Private (\$14.6B; \$2B Series C, Mar 2026)

Nscale, the London-based AI-infrastructure builder behind Stargate UK and Microsoft's Norwegian and Texan capacity, closed a \$2B Series C led by Aker ASA and 8090 Industries at a \$14.6B valuation on 9 March 2026, the largest Series C in European history, with an IPO reported for the second half.

77

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Atlassian  
Williams Racing

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

On 9 March 2026 Nscale announced a \$2B Series C led by Aker ASA and 8090 Industries at a \$14.6B valuation, with Astra Capital Management, Citadel, Dell, Jane Street, Lenovo, Linden Advisors, Nokia, NVIDIA and Point72. It follows a \$1.1B Series B in September 2025, the month Microsoft signed a \$6.2B, five-year capacity contract at Narvik. Nscale formed only in May 2024 as a spin-out from Arkon Energy; in February DCD reported it had hired Goldman Sachs and JPMorgan for a listing in the second half of 2026. **BRITAIN'S SOVEREIGN COMPUTE CHAMPION, PRE-IPO.**

The grid has already priced the neocloud: CoreWeave became Aston Martin Aramco's Official AI Cloud Computing Partner in May 2025, Core Scientific and TWG AI opened Cadillac's roster, and Jane Street, an Nscale investor, has backed CoreWeave, Crusoe and Fluidstack. Every hyperscaler seat is taken, by Oracle, Microsoft, Google Cloud and HP. The one British company building compute at this scale has no seat, and its home race is in July.

WHY NOW

The Series C closed on 9 March and an IPO is reported for the second half of 2026; a listed-company brand is built before the roadshow, not after. The British GP at Silverstone in July is Nscale's home race, and the Loughton GPUs land in the first quarter of 2027.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$2B

\$2B Series C led by Aker ASA and 8090 Industries at a \$14.6B valuation, announced 9 Mar 2026, the largest S...

\$1.1B

It follows a \$1.1B Series B in September 2025, the month Microsoft signed a \$6.2B, five-year capacity contr...

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

|                                  |       |                                 |
|----------------------------------|-------|---------------------------------|
| Atlassian Williams<br>Racing     | OPEN  | no rival in this category lane  |
| McLaren Mastercard<br>F1 Team    | TAKEN | Dell Technologies, Google Cloud |
| Aston Martin<br>Aramco F1 Team   | TAKEN | CoreWeave, NetApp               |
| Mercedes-AMG<br>Petronas F1 Team | TAKEN | Microsoft                       |

BOTTOM LINE

A \$2B Series C at \$14.6B, Microsoft, OpenAI and NVIDIA as anchor partners and a reported second-half listing put Nscale at peak brand-investment authority with its home race in July. Williams runs the most data-native roster on the grid with no compute partner, and the British angle is one no rival neocloud can claim.

WHY ATLASSIAN WILLIAMS RACING

Williams runs the most data-native roster on the grid: Atlassian as title partner, VAST Data for the data platform, Keeper for identity, Airia and Brillio, and since February Claude as Official Thinking Partner inside strategy and car development. It has no cloud or GPU-compute partner. Nscale is the British company building Stargate UK and Microsoft's capacity; Williams is the British team rebuilding on data, and Silverstone is the home race for both. A sovereign-compute story belongs on a British car.

VALUE TO ATLASSIAN WILLIAMS RACING — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. Work outside the aero-testing restrictions is compute-bound: CFD surrogates, driver-in-the-loop and strategy simulation, telemetry and video analytics between sessions. Nscale supplies UK-hosted GPU capacity on demand, so the team's data stays in the country and no cost-cap capital goes on hardware; it is the layer beneath Claude and VAST. In return: a named compute partnership and Silverstone and US-round hospitality for Nscale's hyperscaler and capital-markets audience.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Compute Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, spanning the listing and the Loughton and Texas ramps. Estimated \$5-8M a year, part in compute credits. Scope: engine-cover or sidepod placement, naming of the team's compute environment, British GP and Austin hospitality, engineering content on sovereign compute.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

**Josh Payne**  
FOUNDER & CEO, NSCALE · **VERIFIED**

Payne founded Nscale in May 2024 out of Arkon Energy and has led every raise; a first sports partnership is his call. Path: Lauren Hurwitz, COO since April 2026; Alice Takhtajan, CFO since December 2025; Nidhi Chappell, President of AI Infrastructure. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the home race and the listing.

*“Josh, CoreWeave took its seat at Aston Martin in the year it listed. Williams runs Claude and VAST with no compute partner, and Silverstone is your home race. 25 minutes before the British GP to see the numbers?”*

SCORE COMPOSITION

|                                                                                    |                                                                                           |                                                                                       |                                                                                |                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>TIMING</p> <p><b>14</b> / 20</p> <p>Round closed 9 Mar; British GP in July.</p> | <p>CAPACITY</p> <p><b>19</b> / 20</p> <p>\$2B raised at \$14.6B; \$3B-plus in a year.</p> | <p>BRAND FIT</p> <p><b>15</b> / 20</p> <p>Sovereign-compute archetype; B2B brand.</p> | <p>URGENCY</p> <p><b>14</b> / 20</p> <p>IPO reported for H2; no hard date.</p> | <p>OPS FIT</p> <p><b>15</b> / 20</p> <p>MODE A: UK-hosted GPU capacity for simulation.</p> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

RISKS & COUNTERS

**IPO-YEAR SCRUTINY** A pre-listing company may defer discretionary brand spend until after pricing. **Counter:** Position the deal as the listed-company brand platform, priced now and activated for 2027.

**A CROWDED ARCHETYPE** CoreWeave, Core Scientific, Crusoe and Fluidstack are all courting or holding grid seats. **Counter:** Own the sovereign-UK angle: the only British neocloud at this scale, on a British team with an open compute lane.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- <https://www.nscale.com/about>
- <https://www.nscale.com/press-releases/nscale-series-c>
- <https://www.nscale.com/press-releases/nscale-series-b>
- <https://www.nscale.com/press-releases/nscale-appoints-lauren-hurwitz>